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Questions and
Answers



THE NEW Muslim Guide

A Clear and Friendly Introduction to Islam

Preface

All praise is for Allah — the Lord of mercy, the Giver of guidance, and the One who opens hearts to faith. Peace and blessings be upon His final Messenger, Muhammad ﷺ, whose life remains a timeless example of compassion, wisdom, and clarity.

This booklet has been prepared especially for **new Muslims and sincere seekers of truth** who wish to understand Islam in a simple, logical, and friendly way. Entering Islam is a beautiful beginning — but with that beginning comes the natural desire to learn, ask questions, and build a strong foundation of belief and practice. Many new Muslims feel overwhelmed or unsure about where to start. Others have questions they may hesitate to ask.

This booklet is designed to **answer those questions gently and clearly**. Each question is taken from real conversations with reverts — covering belief, worship, family life, morality, justice, the Qur'an, the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and more.

Our goal is not only to inform, but also to comfort and guide. Islam is a religion of peace, logic, mercy, and balance. It is a faith that speaks to the heart and the mind equally. This booklet is intended to introduce Islam as it truly is: simple, pure, universal, and deeply connected to the natural human soul.

May Allah accept this humble effort, make it beneficial, and place light in the hearts of all who read it.

— **Dr. Munib Siddiqui**

Introduction

Becoming a Muslim is one of the most meaningful decisions a person can make in life. For some, it comes after years of searching; for others, through a sudden spark of clarity. No matter the journey, every new Muslim deserves knowledge, support, and understanding.

Islam encourages questions. The Qur'an repeatedly asks people to think, to reflect, and to use their intellect. For this reason, this booklet presents **Islam in a question-and-answer format** — easy to read, easy to navigate, and easy to share.

What This Booklet Offers

- Clear explanations of Islamic beliefs
- Guidance on worship, family, and daily life
- Understanding of prophets, scriptures, and the Qur'an
- Answers to common misconceptions
- A balanced view of sensitive topics such as Jihad, women's rights, justice, and social ethics
- A foundation to prepare new Muslims for deeper study

Who This Booklet Is For

- Newly reverted Muslims
- Non-Muslims exploring Islam
- Muslims who wish to strengthen their basics
- Teachers, da'wah workers, and mentors

How to Use This Booklet

1. Read at your own pace — Islam is a journey, not a race.
2. Take notes, mark questions, and reflect on how each answer relates to your life.
3. Discuss what you read with a trusted teacher or Muslim mentor.
4. Revisit the topics whenever you feel the need — learning in Islam is lifelong.
5. Remember: even the greatest scholars started with simple questions.

Islam does not demand perfection — only sincerity and effort. Step by step, belief becomes stronger, the heart becomes more peaceful, and life becomes more meaningful.

Welcome to the path of knowledge. May Allah make your journey beautiful.

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1) What is Islam?

Islam is Arabic word which means peace, submission and obedience. It also means acceptance and commitment to abide by the teachings and guidance of God. One of the beautiful names of God is As-Salem (The Peace).

Islam also means to be at peace with God and His creatures. Being at peace with God implies complete submission to His will, Who is the source of all purity and goodness. Being at peace with His creatures implies living in peace within one's self, with other people and with the environment. Thus, Islam is a total system of living in peace. Islam is the same message and guidance which God revealed through all His Prophets to every people throughout the history of mankind. One who follows Islam is called a Muslim (an Arabic word which means, the one who submits to the will of God).

2) Is Islam a new Religion?

No! It is the same religion which was preached by all the prophets and is further elaborated through the Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him. God ordered him:

"Say: We believe in Allah and in that which was revealed to us, and in that which was revealed to Abraham and Ishmael and Isaac and Jacob and the tribes and in that which was given to Moses and to Jesus and to other Prophets from their God; we make no distinction between any of them, and to Him we are Muslims." A I-Qur'an 3:84

The religion of Islam is as old as humanity itself. It was in fact the religion of every prophet of God, who appeared in any part of the world. According to the Quran, Islam was the religion of Adam, Noah, Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, Moses and Jesus, peace be upon them all. However, it was revealed to Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him, in its comprehensive, complete and final form.

3) What is the distinctive Feature of Islam?

The major characteristic of Islam is that through believing in all the Prophets and God's message revealed to each of them; it lays down the basis of peace and harmony among the people of the world. The great mission of Islam is not only to preach the above-mentioned truth, but also to correct those errors which had crept into the prevailing religions. Most important of all, Islam gathers in one book all those truths which were contained in earlier Divine revelations granted to previous Prophets for the guidance of mankind, and to meet all the spiritual and moral requirements of an ever-advancing humanity.

Muslims are encouraged to cooperate with all those who are faithful and God-conscious people, namely those who received scriptures (Torah, Psalms and Gospel) through His Prophets. Christians and Jews are called the "People of the Book:" and their Prophets and Scriptures are honored by the Muslims.

4) How Islam relates to Mankind?

Islam teaches that diversity among human beings is a sign of God's mercy and no one has superiority based on one's color, language or nationality. Islam promotes the brotherhood of man, toleration of one another, sympathy for the unfortunate and cooperation for general human happiness. If there is any religion in the world which has strove to eliminate racism, it is Islam. There is no distinction between men on account of mere birth in a particular family, particular profession, particular race or particular country, and that all human beings are equal. God created people of different colors, nationalities, languages and ethnic origins so that we may recognize one another.

In Islam, superiority is based on the love and fear of God, doing good deeds, and maintaining high moral and spiritual qualities. In many

respects Islam has regulated the relationships between men regardless of creeds, races or colors. One of the aims of Islam is to emphasize the oneness of humanity as a whole and also the Oneness of the Creator of mankind and of all beings. Islam pronounces loudly, dearly, and with great emphasis that all people are, by nature, equal in all respects and that no one is better or superior to anyone else except through piety.

5) Who are the Muslims?

Muslims are those 1.9 billion people (per CIA World's Facts Book in year 2000), from all races, colors, nationalities and cultures who believe in One God (Allah) and accept Muhammad, peace be upon him, as the last Prophet. The majority of Muslims live in Indonesia, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Afghanistan, Iran, Turkey, Iraq, Syria, Jordan, Palestine, Egypt, Libya, Algeria, Morocco, Bosnia and other parts of the continents of Asia and Africa. Significant minorities are in India, China, Russia, Europe, North America (over 9.993 million in the USA) and South America. A Muslim is a person who freely and willingly accepts the supreme power of God and strives to organize his or her life in accordance with His commandments. Hence a Muslim is any person anywhere in the world whose obedience, allegiance, and loyalty are to the One and Only God (Allah), the Creator of the Universe, and as such submits to the Divine Laws following the Sunnah (traditions) of the Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him.

My Lord! Let me die as a Muslim and count me among the righteous

6) What are the Pillars of Imaan (Faith)?

Muslims believe in six main pillars of faith:

1. Belief in One God (Allah):

Allah is the One and Only God who has all perfect and unique qualities.

2. Belief in Angels:

Angels are created by Allah to carry out His commands.

3. Belief in Holy Books:

Muslims believe in all the divine books revealed to the prophets — including the Torah, Psalms, Gospel (Bible), and the Qur'an, which is the final revelation.

4. Belief in Prophets:

Allah sent many prophets to guide humankind, such as Noah, Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, Joseph, Moses, David, Jesus, and Muhammad (peace be upon them all).

5. Belief in the Day of Judgment:

Muslims believe in life after death, where every person will be judged for their deeds and rewarded or punished accordingly.

6. Belief in Al-Qadar (Divine Destiny):

Allah knows everything — what has happened, what is happening, and what will happen in the future.

7) Why Do Muslims Use the Word “Allah” Instead of “God”?

The word “Allah” comes from two Arabic words, “Al-Ilah,” which means The God.

It is the personal name of the One Supreme Being who exists by Himself and possesses all perfect qualities.

- The word Allah has no plural and no gender.
- It has no equivalent in English or any other language.
- It has never been used for anyone other than the One True God.

Interestingly, Aramaic, the language spoken by Prophet Jesus (peace be upon him), also uses the word Allah for God. Even Arab Jews and Christians use this same word.

8) How Can Someone Become a Muslim?

To become a Muslim, a person must believe in One God (Allah) and accept Muhammad (peace be upon him) as His final Prophet.

The declaration of faith, called the Shahadah, is said as follows:

“La ilaha illallah, Muhammadur Rasoolullah.”

Meaning: “There is no god except Allah, and Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.”

After saying this with belief, a person follows the teachings of the Qur’an and the Sunnah (traditions of Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him).

9) What is Prophethood in Islam?

Allah, the Merciful and Loving, not only created human beings but also guided them by appointing Prophets throughout history.

- Prophets were honest, truthful, and noble people chosen by Allah.
- Allah revealed His messages to them so they could teach humanity what is right and what is wrong.
- Every nation received one or more prophets for guidance.

The purpose of Prophethood is to:

- Teach people why they were created.
- Explain life after death and accountability for actions.
- Guide people toward truth, goodness, and the right path.

- Warn people about the results of evil deeds and give good news to those who do good.

Prophethood shows Allah's love and mercy for humankind, as He continuously provided guidance for people to live with faith and righteousness.

Muslims believe that all prophets were sent by the same One God (Allah) with a consistent message. Therefore, Muslims make no distinction among them and respect all prophets equally.

10) Who is Muhammad (Peace Be Upon Him)?

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) is the last Prophet of God, sent for the guidance of all humankind. He was chosen by Allah to show people the right path and to be a perfect example of good character and behavior.

1. His Birth and Early Life

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was born in Makkah (Saudi Arabia) in the year 570 AD.

From a young age, he was known for his honesty and truthfulness. People called him Al-Ameen (the Trustworthy) and As-Sadiq (the Truthful).

He lived a simple and peaceful life. He often went to a cave called Hira, near Makkah, to think and meditate about the purpose of life and the Creator.

2. The First Revelation

When Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was 40 years old, the Angel Gabriel (Jibreel) came to him with the first revelation from Allah while he was in the Cave of Hira.

Although he could neither read nor write, Allah chose him to deliver His message to the world — a message of peace, justice, and faith in One God.

3. His Mission

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was sent to:

- Guide people to worship only Allah.
- Teach truth, kindness, and justice.
- Help people live righteous and meaningful lives.

He faced many difficulties and hardships while spreading Allah's message, but he always remained patient and firm in his mission.

4. The Migration (Hijrah)

After 13 years of preaching in Makkah, he and his followers faced severe persecution.

Allah then gave him permission to migrate to a city called Yathrib, later known as Al-Madinah.

This event, called the Hijrah, happened in 622 AD and marks the beginning of the Islamic calendar.

5. His Character and Legacy

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) lived a life full of wisdom, humility, and compassion.

He was:

- A teacher,
- A leader,
- A lawgiver,
- And a role model for all people.

Every aspect of his life — from childhood to leadership — is well recorded in history, making him the most well-documented prophet in the world.

A Reflection by a Non-Muslim Scholar

The French historian Lamartine wrote about Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him):

“If greatness of purpose, smallness of means, and amazing results are the marks of human genius, who can compare to Muhammad? He moved not only armies and nations but also the hearts and souls of millions. He founded a great spiritual nation and united people of all races and languages. By every standard of greatness, is there any man greater than he?”

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) is the final messenger of Allah, sent to guide all people to truth, peace, and the worship of one God.

His life remains a complete example of mercy, justice, and humanity for all times.

11) What is Sunnah?

Sunnah means the sayings, actions, and approvals of the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

It is the second source of Islamic law after the Qur'an.

The Sunnah helps Muslims understand the Qur'an better — it explains how to follow the teachings of Islam in daily life.

The sayings and actions of the Prophet are recorded in books called Hadith.

Examples of the Prophet's Sayings:

- A person is not a true believer until he wishes for his brother what he wishes for himself.
- It is not right for a believer to stop talking to his brother for more than three days.
- Whoever is ungrateful to people is ungrateful to God.
- Welcome and respect your community leader when he visits you.
- Actions are judged by intentions.
- The best way in everything is moderation.
- This world is a prison for the believer and a paradise for the unbeliever.
- The survival of a king's rule depends on forgiveness.
- The upper hand (the one that gives) is better than the lower hand (the one that takes).
- A true Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hands other Muslims are safe.

12) What Does Islam Say About the Torah and the Bible?

Islam teaches that Muslims must believe in all previous holy books, including the Torah (Taurat) and the Gospel (Injeel/Bible).

These were originally true revelations from Allah, sent to earlier prophets.

However, over time, the original words were changed or lost through translation and human editing. Because of this, they no longer exist in their pure form.

The Qur'an explains that Allah sent Prophet Jesus (peace be upon him) to confirm what remained true in the Torah, and gave him the Gospel as guidance and light.

Later, Allah revealed the Qur'an to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him), confirming the truth of earlier scriptures and protecting it from alteration.

The Qur'an says each nation was given its own law and way of life, and Allah tests everyone by what He has given. Therefore, we should all strive to do good. (Reference: Qur'an 5:46–48)

13) How Does Islam View Judaism and Christianity?

Islam refers to Jews and Christians as “People of the Book” because they received earlier revelations from Allah through prophets like Moses (Musa) and Jesus (Isa).

Islam teaches respect for them and invites them to unite on the common belief in One God.

The Qur'an says:

“O People of the Book! Let us agree on one thing — that we worship none but Allah, and do not associate partners with Him.” (Qur'an 3:64)

Prophet Abraham (peace be upon him) is described in the Qur'an as neither a Jew nor a Christian, but a Muslim who submitted to Allah.

Islam teaches that all prophets — including Abraham, Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob, Moses, Jesus, and Muhammad (peace be upon them all) — brought the same message of faith and obedience to God.

Muslims are told to believe in all prophets and all revealed scriptures without making any distinction between them.

Islam also allows Muslims to eat the food of the People of the Book and marry their chaste women, as long as they follow Islamic principles. (Qur'an 5:5)

14) What Does Islam Say About Original Sin?

Islam teaches that every person is born pure and sinless. One of the most misunderstood topics in human life is the concept of sin—how it began and what it means for humanity.

According to Islam, the story of Adam and Eve (peace be upon them) holds an important lesson, but not one of inherited guilt. The Qur'an tells us that God placed Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden and allowed them to enjoy everything in it, except for one specific tree. God warned them not to follow Satan's whispers, as that would lead to harm and wrongdoing.

However, Satan deceived them, and they disobeyed God's command. When they realized their mistake, they felt deep regret and sincerely asked for forgiveness. God forgave them because He is Most Merciful and Forgiving.

This means that there is no concept of "original sin" in Islam. Human beings are not born sinful or burdened with the sins of their ancestors. Each person is born in a state of purity and innocence, known as *fitrah*—a natural state of submission to God.

What happens after birth depends on one's environment, upbringing, and personal choices. Everyone has free will to choose between right and wrong, and each person is responsible for their own actions.

In Islam, being human means having weaknesses and making mistakes. It is not a sin to be imperfect, but it is a sin to know the right path and deliberately choose the wrong one.

A sin in Islam is any act, thought, or intention that:

- Is done knowingly and deliberately
- Goes against God's clear commands

- Violates the rights of God or other people
- Harms the soul or the body
- Can be avoided, but is still committed
- Is done repeatedly without repentance

Sin is not inherited—it is a personal choice. Every person has the capacity for both good and evil. Choosing goodness keeps one's nature pure; choosing wrongdoing adds impurity for which the person alone is accountable.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) taught that God's mercy is always greater than His punishment, and that repentance wipes away sin. Therefore, Islam encourages believers to turn back to God sincerely whenever they err.

“O Allah! Grant me a good life, and let me die on the right path.”

(Supplication of the Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him)

Indeed, Allah speaks the truth.

A person becomes sinful only when they knowingly commit a wrong act after understanding right and wrong.

The Qur'an says that each soul knows what is right and what is wrong — the successful person is the one who keeps it pure. (Qur'an 91:7–10)

Every person is responsible for their own deeds — no one carries the sin of another. (Qur'an 6:164, 17:15)

All children who die before understanding right and wrong go directly to Paradise.

This is one of the main differences between Islam and Christianity, where the concept of original sin exists.

15) What Does Islam Say About Jesus (Peace Be Upon Him)?

In Islam, Jesus (Isa) is one of the great prophets of God, just like Noah, Abraham, Moses, David, and Muhammad (peace be upon them all).

He was a human being and the son of Mary (Maryam).

He was born miraculously without a father, by Allah’s command — just as Adam was created without a father or mother.

Allah gave him miracles, such as healing the blind and the sick, and raising the dead, by Allah’s permission.

The Qur’an teaches that Jesus (peace be upon him) was a prophet and servant of God, not the son of God.

Allah says:

“Do not say ‘Trinity’. God is One and does not need a son.” (Qur’an 4:171)

The Qur’an also states that the Jews did not kill or crucify Jesus — Allah raised him up, and he will return before the Day of Judgment. (Qur’an 4:156–159)

On that day, Allah will ask Jesus about what people claimed about him, and he will testify that he only told people to worship Allah alone. (Qur’an 5:116–118)

Muslims believe that Mary (Maryam) is one of the purest women ever created, and a full chapter of the Qur’an (Surah 19) is named after her.

16) What is the Qur'an?

The Qur'an is the final word of God, revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) through Angel Gabriel (Jibreel).

It is the main source of Islamic teachings and laws and covers every aspect of human life — belief, morality, worship, wisdom, justice, and relationships with God and people.

The Qur'an provides complete guidance for building a just and balanced society, including principles for social justice, politics, economics, law, and international relations.

The Qur'an was revealed gradually over 23 years to answer people's questions, solve problems, and guide humanity to truth and happiness.

1. Preservation of the Qur'an

Every letter of the Qur'an is the word of God. It was revealed in Arabic and has been preserved exactly as it was revealed, without any change in wording or punctuation.

Allah Himself promised to protect it from alteration.

The Qur'an has 114 chapters (called Surahs) and over 6,000 verses (Ayahs).

It is the only religious book in history that remains completely unchanged since its revelation. Even non-Muslim scholars agree that its text has never been altered.

The Qur'an is a miracle — no human being can produce even one chapter like it.

2. The Message and Nature of the Qur'an

The Qur'an is not just a book of laws or history; it is a book of divine guidance that reveals the greatness, mercy, and wisdom of God.

Millions of Muslims have memorized the entire Qur'an, word for word — something unique to this scripture.

The original Arabic Qur'an and translations of its meaning are available in almost every language and country.

Within a short time, the teachings of the Qur'an removed evil practices like idol worship, drinking, gambling, and injustice from society. It turned the people of Arabia — once uneducated and divided — into leaders of knowledge, science, and morality.

The Qur'an continues to inspire people with its powerful message and unmatched beauty.

17) Does Islam Recognize Science and Technology?

Yes. Islam encourages the pursuit of knowledge, science, and discovery.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said that seeking knowledge is an obligation for every Muslim man and woman.

Science and technology in Islam must be used for good purposes, to benefit humanity and to understand the power and glory of God.

The Qur'an says:

“Read! Your Lord is the Most Gracious, Who taught by the pen, taught man what he did not know.” (Qur'an 96:3–5)

“We will show them Our signs in the universe and within themselves until it becomes clear that this Qur'an is the truth.” (Qur'an 41:53)

Because of the Qur'an's emphasis on knowledge, early Muslims became pioneers in science, especially in medicine, mathematics, chemistry, physics, astronomy, geography, architecture, and literature.

They invented tools such as the astrolabe and quadrant, developed the concept of zero, Arabic numerals, and algebra — all of which contributed greatly to European civilization and the Renaissance.

18) What is Worship in Islam?

In Islam, worship (Ibadah) means any action done sincerely for the sake of Allah and according to His guidance.

Worship is not limited to prayers or rituals — even working, studying, helping others, or raising a family can be acts of worship if done with good intentions and in obedience to God.

The Qur'an says:

“Say: My prayer, my sacrifice, my life, and my death are all for Allah, the Lord of all worlds. He has no partner, and I am commanded to be among the Muslims.”(Qur'an 6:162–163)

Islam teaches that faith must be shown through actions. Worship means loving God, doing good deeds, and avoiding injustice and wrongdoing.

The Qur'an says:

“Righteousness is not turning your faces to the east or the west, but righteousness is to believe in Allah, the Last Day, the Angels, the Book, and the Prophets — and to give wealth to the poor and needy, to keep promises, and to be patient in hardship.”(Qur'an 2:177)

19) What Are the Five Pillars of Islam?

The Five Pillars of Islam are the foundation of a Muslim's faith and practice. They provide a framework for spiritual life and connection with God.

1. Declaration of Faith (Shahadah)

To say and believe:

“La ilaha illallah, Muhammadur Rasoolullah”

“There is no god but Allah, and Muhammad is His Messenger.”

This means believing in One God and following the example of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

2. Prayer (Salah)

Muslims pray five times a day — at dawn, noon, afternoon, sunset, and night.

Prayer connects a person directly to God and keeps the heart pure.

The Qur'an mentions that even Prophet Jesus (peace be upon him) was commanded to pray and give charity. (Qur'an 19:30–31)

Muslims can pray anywhere — at home, work, or in a mosque — and there is no priesthood in Islam. Prayers are led by the most knowledgeable person in the Qur'an.

3. Almsgiving (Zakat)

Zakat means purification. Muslims give a small portion of their savings (usually 2.5%) each year to help the poor, needy, and community welfare projects.

Zakat reduces poverty, encourages sharing, and strengthens social justice. Giving more than the required amount is called Sadaqah (voluntary charity).

4. Fasting (Sawm)

During the month of Ramadan, Muslims fast from dawn to sunset — avoiding food, drink, and immoral behavior.

Fasting teaches self-control, patience, and compassion for the poor.

It also strengthens faith and spiritual discipline.

At the end of Ramadan, Muslims celebrate Eid al-Fitr, a festival marked by prayer and charity.

5. Pilgrimage (Hajj)

Every Muslim who is physically and financially able must perform Hajj to Makkah at least once in their lifetime.

Millions of Muslims from all over the world gather to worship together, showing unity and equality among all people.

Hajj includes visiting the Ka'bah, walking between the hills of Safa and Marwa, and standing in prayer at Arafat.

It ends with Eid al-Adha, when Muslims remember the sacrifice of Prophet Abraham (peace be upon him) and share food with the poor.

20) What is the Ka'bah?

The Ka'bah is the central place of worship for all Muslims. It is located in Makkah, Saudi Arabia, inside the Sacred Mosque (Al-Masjid Al-Haram).

It is believed to be the first House of God on earth, originally built by Prophet Adam (peace be upon him). It was later rebuilt by Prophet Abraham and his son Ishmael (peace be upon them) after the Great Flood during Prophet Noah's time.

The Ka'bah is a cube-shaped building and is the direction (Qiblah) toward which Muslims all over the world face when they pray.

Every year, millions of Muslims visit the Ka'bah during Hajj (the annual pilgrimage) and Umrah (a smaller pilgrimage that can be performed any time of the year).

The Sacred Mosque can hold over a million worshippers at once.

21) What Are Human Rights in Islam?

Islam commands justice, equality, and kindness to all people, regardless of race, religion, or background.

It strongly forbids oppression, discrimination, and injustice of any kind.

In Islam, the life, honor, and property of every person are sacred. These rights are given by God, not by governments or kings, so no one has the right to take them away.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

“O mankind, you are all children of Adam, and Adam was created from dust.”

Basic Human Rights in Islam

- Islam guarantees several essential rights for all people, including:
- The right to life and safety

- The right to dignity and honor
- Freedom of belief and expression
- The right to privacy
- Equality before the law
- The right to justice and protest against oppression
- The right to food, shelter, and healthcare
- The right to participate in public affairs

The Qur'an says:

“O believers! Be steadfast for the sake of Allah and be fair in your judgment. Do not let hatred of others make you unjust. Be just, for that is closer to righteousness.”
(Qur'an 5:8)

Islam also declares:

“There is no compulsion in religion.” (Qur'an 2:256)

And:

“O mankind! We created you from a male and a female and made you into nations and tribes so that you may know one another.” (Qur'an 49:13)

Islam therefore teaches universal brotherhood, peace, tolerance, and compassion.

22) What Does Islam Say About Justice?

Justice is a central principle in Islam. The Qur'an commands Muslims to be fair and truthful, even if justice goes against themselves, their family, or their interests.

“O believers! Stand firmly for justice, as witnesses to Allah, even if it be against yourselves, your parents, or relatives.” (Qur’an 4:135)

“Do not let hatred of others make you act unjustly. Be just; that is nearer to piety.” (Qur’an 5:8)

Islam teaches that peace cannot exist without justice. Muslims are commanded to stand against oppression, racism, poverty, and intolerance, and to work for fairness in all areas of life.

“Cooperate with one another in goodness and righteousness, and do not cooperate in sin and injustice.” (Qur’an 5:2)

Justice is the foundation of peace in both personal and public life.

23) What is Jihad in Islam?

The word Jihad means “to struggle” or “to strive.”

It does not mean fighting or violence. The main goal of Jihad is self-improvement and striving for goodness.

There are three main types of Jihad:

1. Jihad al-Nafs (Struggle against oneself):

To fight against one’s own bad desires, laziness, and weakness.

2. Jihad ash-Shaytan (Struggle against Satan):

To resist temptation and avoid sin.

3. Jihad al-Kuffar (Struggle against oppressors):

To defend the truth, protect the weak, and fight only in self-defense when no peaceful solution remains.

Islam forbids wars of aggression or fighting for wealth, power, or revenge.

It allows fighting only as a last resort — to defend faith, life, and justice.

During war, Islam forbids harming civilians, women, children, the elderly, religious leaders, crops, or animals.

“Fight in the cause of Allah those who fight against you, but do not go beyond limits. Allah does not love those who transgress.” (Qur’an 2:190)

“If your enemies incline toward peace, then make peace with them.” (Qur’an 8:61)

So, the purpose of Jihad is to protect peace, not to destroy it.

24) What is Hijaab (Islamic Dress Code)?

The Qur’an teaches that both men and women should dress modestly and behave with dignity.

For Men:

Men should lower their gaze and guard their modesty, wearing loose clothing that covers at least from the navel to the knees.

For Women:

Women are also told to dress modestly, cover their bodies except the face and hands, and not display beauty or jewelry in public.

They should also cover their hair and wear loose-fitting clothes that do not show the shape of the body.

“Tell the believing men to lower their gaze and guard their modesty. Tell the believing women to lower their gaze, guard their modesty, and draw their veils over their chests.” (Qur’an 24:30–31)

The purpose of Hijaab is to promote respect, modesty, and purity in society, and to prevent harm, temptation, and exploitation of either gender.

Men are forbidden from wearing gold or pure silk, as these are reserved for women.

Islamic dress may vary across cultures, but its purpose is always modesty and self-respect.

25) How Does Islam View Family Life?

The family is the foundation of Islamic society. It provides love, protection, and moral guidance.

Each family member has rights and responsibilities toward the others.

Parents must care for and guide their children; children must love and respect their parents.

Elders are honored, and the young are treated with compassion.

Islam forbids immoral relationships, trial marriages, or living together outside marriage.

Marriage is the only proper way to form a family, ensuring love, trust, and stability.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said that marriage completes half of one’s faith.

26) What is the Status of Women in Islam?

Islam teaches that men and women are equal in worth and spirituality.

They are partners who complement each other.

Both have the same responsibilities before God, and both are encouraged to seek knowledge and do good deeds.

Women in Islam have the right to:

- Own property and wealth
- Receive inheritance
- Work and earn income
- Vote and give opinions
- Receive respect and protection

At marriage, a woman receives a dowry (mahr) which is hers alone. She keeps her own family name and cannot be forced to marry against her will.

The Qur'an says:

“Whoever does good, whether male or female, and is a believer — they will enter Paradise, and not the least injustice will be done to them.” (Qur'an 4:124)

Islam forbids all forms of abuse, exploitation, or violence against women.

27) What is Marriage in Islam?

Marriage in Islam is a simple legal and spiritual contract between a man and a woman to live together as husband and wife.

It is based on mutual love, respect, and understanding.

No one can be forced into marriage. A woman has the right to accept or refuse any proposal.

“And among His signs is that He created for you spouses from among yourselves so that you may find peace and comfort in them, and He placed between you love and mercy.” (Qur’an 30:21)

Both husband and wife have equal rights and shared responsibilities.

The husband provides and protects, while the wife manages the home and nurtures the family — but both consult each other and show kindness.

If a couple cannot live peacefully, Islam allows divorce as a last resort, but it discourages it.

In case of divorce, the mother has priority in caring for young children, and the father must provide financial support.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

“The best among you are those who are best to their wives.”

28) Why is More Than One Wife Permitted in Islam?

Islam allows a man to marry up to four wives, but only if he can treat them all fairly and equally.

This is not encouraged, only permitted in special cases — such as caring for widows or orphans.

“Marry women of your choice — two, three, or four — but if you fear you cannot be just, then marry only one.” (Qur’an 4:3)

This permission was revealed to limit the number of wives and to ensure justice.

Most Muslim men have only one wife, as fairness among multiple wives is very difficult.

Marriage must always be based on consent — no woman can be forced to marry anyone.

29) What Does Islam Say About Parents and the Elderly?

Islam places great importance on honoring and caring for parents and the elderly. After obedience to God, parents hold the highest position of respect and gratitude.

The Qur'an says:

“Your Lord has commanded that you worship none but Him, and be kind to your parents. If either or both of them reach old age with you, do not say to them a word of disrespect or scold them, but speak to them kindly. Lower to them the wings of humility out of mercy and say: ‘My Lord, have mercy on them, as they raised me when I was small.’” (Qur'an 17:23–25)

God Himself chooses a person's parents and children, and He expects believers to honor His choice by treating their parents with love, patience, and respect.

In Islam, caring for elderly parents is considered both a duty and a blessing, not a burden. Nursing homes are discouraged; instead, Muslims are encouraged to look after their elders personally, as an act of love and devotion.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

“Paradise lies under the feet of your mother.”

Serving one’s parents is a duty second only to prayer. Muslims are expected to show compassion and gratitude, especially when parents reach old age. All elders in society deserve respect, regardless of their relation.

A man once asked the Prophet (peace be upon him):

“O Messenger of God, who is most deserving of my good companionship?”

The Prophet replied, “Your mother.”

The man asked again, “Then who?”

The Prophet replied, “Your mother.”

The man asked a third time, “Then who?”

The Prophet replied, “Your mother.”

The man asked once more, “Then who?”

The Prophet said, “Your father.”

Thus, a mother holds three times more right to love and respect, followed by the father.

30) What Does Islam Say About Food?

Islam teaches that what we eat affects our body, mind, and behavior. Therefore, Muslims are instructed to eat pure, lawful (halal), and wholesome (tayyib) food.

Islam forbids eating carnivorous or predatory animals such as lions, tigers, leopards, wolves, dogs, and cats, because these animals are

violent and eating them could promote aggression. Similarly, birds of prey like eagles, vultures, owls, and crows are also forbidden.

Permissible animals are herbivores such as cows, goats, and sheep—peaceful animals that are beneficial to humans.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) forbade the consumption of:

- Wild animals with fangs or tusks
- Birds with claws or talons
- Reptiles such as snakes and alligators
- Rodents and scavengers

Islam encourages moderation in eating and drinking. The Qur'an allows all foods that are pure, clean, and beneficial, and forbids those that are harmful, impure, or intoxicating.

“Your body has a right over you,”

Said the Prophet (peace be upon him), reminding us that good health is a gift from God.

The Qur'an specifically forbids:

The flesh of dead animals (not slaughtered properly)

Pork

Any animal sacrificed in the name of other than God

Maintaining a balanced, healthy diet is not just a health recommendation—it is a religious duty in Islam.

31) What Does Islam Say About Intoxicants and Gambling?

Islam strongly prohibits all intoxicants and gambling, considering them harmful to the mind, body, and soul.

The Qur'an says:

“O believers! Intoxicants, gambling, idolatry, and divination are all evil acts of Satan’s handiwork. Avoid them so that you may succeed. Satan only wishes to create enmity and hatred among you through intoxicants and gambling, and to prevent you from remembering Allah and from prayer. Will you not then abstain?” (Qur’an 5:90–92)

Intoxicants—such as alcohol, drugs, or any substance that clouds the mind—lead to loss of self-control and moral decay. A drunk person cannot distinguish between right and wrong, which causes harm to individuals, families, and society.

Gambling, likewise, promotes greed, addiction, and financial ruin. It destroys wealth, breaks families, and creates hatred among people.

Islam teaches that prosperity and peace come only through honest work and self-control, not through luck or intoxication.

32) What Does Islam Say About Business Interaction?

Islam provides clear guidance for fair and honest business dealings.

The Qur'an encourages transparency, written agreements, and witnesses in financial transactions.

“O believers! When you make a loan for a fixed term, write it down. Let a scribe write it fairly between you. Let the debtor dictate, and let him fear Allah, his Lord,

and not reduce anything of it. If the debtor is weak or unable, let his guardian dictate justly. And bring two witnesses from among your men. If two men cannot be found, then one man and two women as witnesses, so that if one forgets, the other may remind her. Do not be weary to write it, whether it be small or large, for this is more just in the sight of Allah.” (Qur’an 2:282)

This verse—the longest in the Qur’an—shows how deeply Islam values honesty, record-keeping, and accountability in all business matters.

It aims to prevent disputes, injustice, and deceit, ensuring fairness and trust among all parties.

33) What is the Concept of God in Islam?

In Islam, God (Allah) is One, Eternal, and Absolute.

He is the Creator and Sustainer of everything, and nothing is like Him.

“Say: He is Allah, the One and Only. Allah, the Eternal, Absolute. He begets not, nor is He begotten. And there is none comparable to Him.” (Qur’an 112:1–4)

The word “Allah” has no plural or gender, emphasizing the uniqueness and oneness of God.

He has no partners, no children, and no equals. Everything in the universe depends on Him, but He depends on nothing.

Islam rejects the idea that God could take human form, have a family, or show favoritism based on race or wealth.

All human beings are equal before God, and the only way to gain His favor is through faith and righteousness.

“Surely Allah does not forgive associating partners with Him (shirk), but He forgives anything else for whom He wills.” (Qur’an 4:48, 116)

God’s mercy is vast and boundless. He loves His creation and provides them with everything they need—body, mind, and soul. His mercy brings comfort, strength, and peace to those who turn to Him.

34) What is the Concept of Life in Islam?

Life is a gift and trust from God.

It is not an accident, but a purposeful creation demonstrating God’s wisdom, power, and artistry.

Human life belongs to God alone—He gives life and He takes it away. Therefore, suicide, self-harm, or unjust killing are all forbidden in Islam.

Islam teaches that life is a temporary journey toward the eternal life of the Hereafter.

Each person is a traveler, and their actions in this life determine their state in the next.

“We have indeed created man in the best form.”
(Qur’an 95:4)

Life on earth is a test. Success lies in using this life wisely—doing good deeds, avoiding sin, and following God’s guidance.

When a person dies, their soul moves on to the next stage of existence.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) advised:

“Be in this world as if you are a stranger or a traveler passing through.”

35) What is the Concept of Life After Death in Islam?

Islam teaches that earthly life is only the beginning. Every soul will be resurrected for judgment before God.

On the Day of Judgment, everyone will see the record of their deeds—good or bad—and be rewarded or punished accordingly.

“Our Lord, grant us good in this world and good in the Hereafter, and protect us from the torment of the Fire.”
(Qur’an 2:201)

Those who lived righteously will enter Paradise, a place of eternal peace, while those who were unjust and rebellious will face punishment in Hell.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

“In Paradise, there are things that no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, and no mind has ever imagined.”

Belief in the Hereafter gives meaning to life and encourages moral behavior. It ensures that every person is accountable and that ultimate justice will be served — even for deeds that go unpunished in this world.

Without belief in life after death, life would be unjust, for many evildoers escape punishment on earth while the innocent suffer. Islam therefore affirms that the next life is eternal, where everyone will receive their full due.

Summary of the Booklet

This booklet answers essential questions that new Muslims commonly ask when first entering Islam. It explains:

1. The Basics of Faith

- What Islam is
- Why it is not a new religion
- The six pillars of belief
- Why Muslims use the name “Allah”
- How to become a Muslim

2. Prophets & Scriptures

- Prophethood
- Life of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ
- The Qur'an and earlier scriptures
- Islam's relationship with Jews and Christians

3. Human Life & Morality

- Original sin vs. human responsibility
- The Islamic concept of sin and repentance
- The status of Jesus ﷺ
- Justice, human rights, and social ethics

4. Worship & Pillars of Islam

- Nature of worship in Islam
- Five pillars of Islam
- Prayer, fasting, charity, and Hajj
- The Ka'bah and Islamic rituals

5. Daily Life in Islam

- Hijaab
- Marriage and family life
- Women's rights
- Business ethics
- Halal food
- Social conduct
- Avoiding intoxicants and gambling

6. Spiritual Worldview

- Concept of God (Allah)
- Purpose of life
- Life after death
- Meaning of destiny

Together, these questions form a **complete and welcoming overview of Islam**, providing new Muslims with a strong, balanced foundation. The booklet encourages reflection, personal growth, and the pursuit of deeper knowledge.

THE NEW
**MUSLIM
GUIDE**

Questions and Answers has been developed to address some of the most commonly asked questions by those new to Islam. it provides straightforward answers in simple language, making it an invaluable resource for new Muslims seeking clarity and understanding on key aspects of the faith.



by Dr. Munib Siddiqui